

trident, and a long dagger. Their only armor was an arm guard (*manica*) and shoulder guard (*galerus*) protecting the left arm. Apart from a loincloth, they were naked. This gladiator used the net to catch an opponent, who was usually a *secutor*. The *retiarius's* net was weighted with small pieces of lead, which made it spread out easier and quicker when thrown at a *secutor*.

Sagittarius ("archer")

Fought from horseback with a powerful bow, which fired arrows over distances of up to 660 ft (200 m).

Samnite

The oldest type of gladiator, the Samnite was named after an Italian people conquered by the Romans in 290 BCE. These fighters were armed like Samnite warriors, with a rectangular shield, a greave on the left leg, a straight sword, and a helmet decorated with feathers.

Scissor ("cutter")

Apart from the name, almost nothing is known about this gladiator's arms or armor. There is one image of a fighter whose forearm is encased in a metal tube with a curved blade at the end, like the hooks worn by pirates in stories. Perhaps this gladiator was a Scissor.

Secutor ("chaser")

Secutores wore an egg-shaped helmet with two small eye holes designed to protect them from their usual opponents, *retiarii*. These gladiators'

smooth helmet would not get caught in the *retiarius's* net, and the eye holes prevented the prongs of the trident from blinding them. A *secutor* carried a sword and a long rectangular shield.

Tertiarius ("third fighter")

Sometimes three gladiators were matched against each other. The first two would fight, only for the winner to be met by the third, the *tertiarius*.

Thraex ("Thracian")

The *thraex's* equipment was based on that of the warriors of Thrace, north of the Black Sea. Like real Thracians, a *thraex* carried a short curved sword and a small, round shield. Because these fighters carried small shields, they had extra body protection, with greaves on both legs and a *manica* on their right arm. They wore a broad-brimmed helmet topped with a crest of a griffin, a mythical part-eagle and part-lion creature thought to live in Thrace.

Veles ("skirmisher")

Fought with a spear attached to a leash so that after it was thrown, it could be pulled back.

Venator ("hunter")

Hunted wild animals in the arena armed with a bow and arrow, a sword, or a spear. *Venatores* wore no armor and often worked in pairs, assisted by *bestiarii*.